

035. Chapter 3 Verses 28-29

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.28

तत्त्ववित्तु महाबाहो गुणकर्मविभागयोः ।
गुणा गुणेषु वर्तन्त इति मत्वा न सज्जते ॥ 28 ॥

tattvavittu mahābāho
guṇakarmavibhāgayoḥ |
guṇā guṇeṣu vartanta
iti matvā na sajjate ||

◆ tattva-vit – knower of Truth; tu – but; mahābāho – O mighty-armed; ◆ guṇa-karma-vibhāgayoḥ – of the divisions of modes and actions; ◆ guṇāḥ – the modes; guṇeṣu – in the modes; vartante – operate; ◆ iti – thus; matvā – knowing; na – not; sajjate – becomes attached.

O mighty-armed Arjuna! But the knower of Truth understands the divisions of qualities and functions. He knows that the qualities in the form of senses function amidst the objects of the senses, and he, as the Supreme Self, is not affected by them. Thus knowing, he remains unattached.

VERSE 3.29

प्रकृतेर्गुणसम्मूढाः सज्जन्ते गुणकर्मसु ।
तानकृत्स्नविदो मन्दान्कृत्स्नविन्न विचालयेत् ॥ 29 ॥

prakṛterguṇasammūḍhāḥ
sajjante guṇakarmasu |
tānakṛtsnavido mandān
kṛtsnavinna vicālayet ||

◆ prakṛteḥ – of nature; guṇa-sammūḍhāḥ – deluded by the modes; ◆ sajjante – become attached; guṇa-karmasu – to the actions of the modes; ◆ tān – those; akṛtsna-vidaḥ – of imperfect knowledge; mandān – the dull-witted; ◆ kṛtsna-vit – the knower of the Whole (the wise); na – not; vicālayet – should unsettle.

The man of knowledge should not confuse the mind of those men of imperfect understanding who, deluded by the Gunas of Nature, are attached to action in the material world.